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Case Studies and Application of Spreadsheets

We’ve covered the importance of Excel for consultants, the essential spreadsheet skills needed, and how to automate routine tasks using macros and VBA. To further illustrate these concepts, let’s review examples of spreadsheets applied in consulting projects.

Case 1: Qualitative Customer Data Synthesis for New Product Launch

A major FMCG (fast-moving consumer goods) company wanted to launch a new product in the snacks category targeted at urban youth.

As consultants, you would advise:



Consultant

- Optimal product positioning
- Pricing
- Marketing strategy based on consumer research

Data Collection & Consolidation in Excel

The first step involved accumulating and consolidating all the relevant data sources into an Excel database:

- Purchased quantitative consumer survey data with responses across multiple cities
- Created a data entry worksheet for qualitative inputs like focus group notes, social media comments, field observations, etc.
- Imported store audit data capturing competitor product details from retail outlets
- Pulled in publicly available data on demographic segments, media consumption, etc.

With all data sources combined into one place, Excel now acted as the core foundation to derive insights from this disparate information.